



EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

**Self-esteem**

# Self-esteem

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30%

of ResilienceBuilder respondents  
experience challenges with self-esteem

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89%

of people with **high levels** of  
resilience had high self-esteem

61%

of people with **average levels** of  
resilience had high self-esteem

20%

of people with **low levels** of  
resilience had high self-esteem

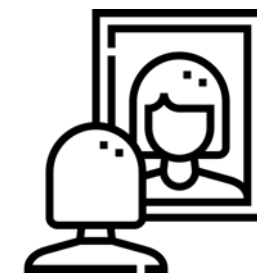




# Self-esteem



What is self-esteem?



Self-esteem is how we value and perceive ourselves.



It's based on our opinions and beliefs about ourselves, which can sometimes feel really difficult to change. (MIND 2019). Self-esteem affects multiple areas of life including relationships and career.



Signs of low self-esteem:

- Avoiding challenges and opportunities
- Avoiding responsibilities
- Being overly dependent on others
- Relying on others to make decisions
- Putting yourself down and over-apologising
- Isolating yourself
- Becoming highly emotional, possibly depressed



## Self-esteem



What can cause low self-esteem?

### Typically stressful life experiences, including:



Losing your job or difficulty finding a job



Experiencing discrimination



Being bullied or abused



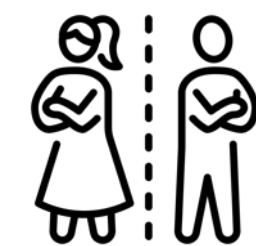
Problems at work



Ongoing stress



Physical and mental health problems



Relationship problems, separation or divorce



Concerns over your appearance and body image



Financial problems



# Most People Derive Their Self-esteem From:



1

## COMPETENCY

Competencies and skills, e.g. academic achievement.



2

## COMPETITION

Being better than others.



3

## APPROVAL

Receiving approval and acceptance from others.



4

## FAMILY SUPPORT

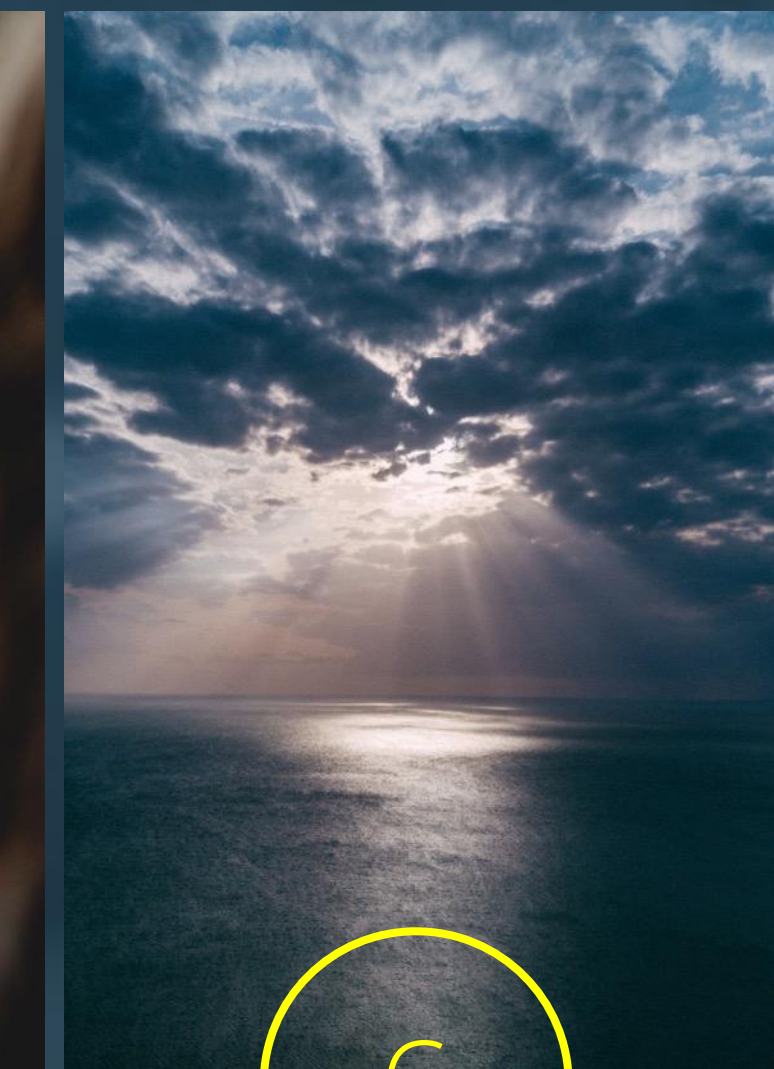
Love and support of family.



5

## APPEARANCE

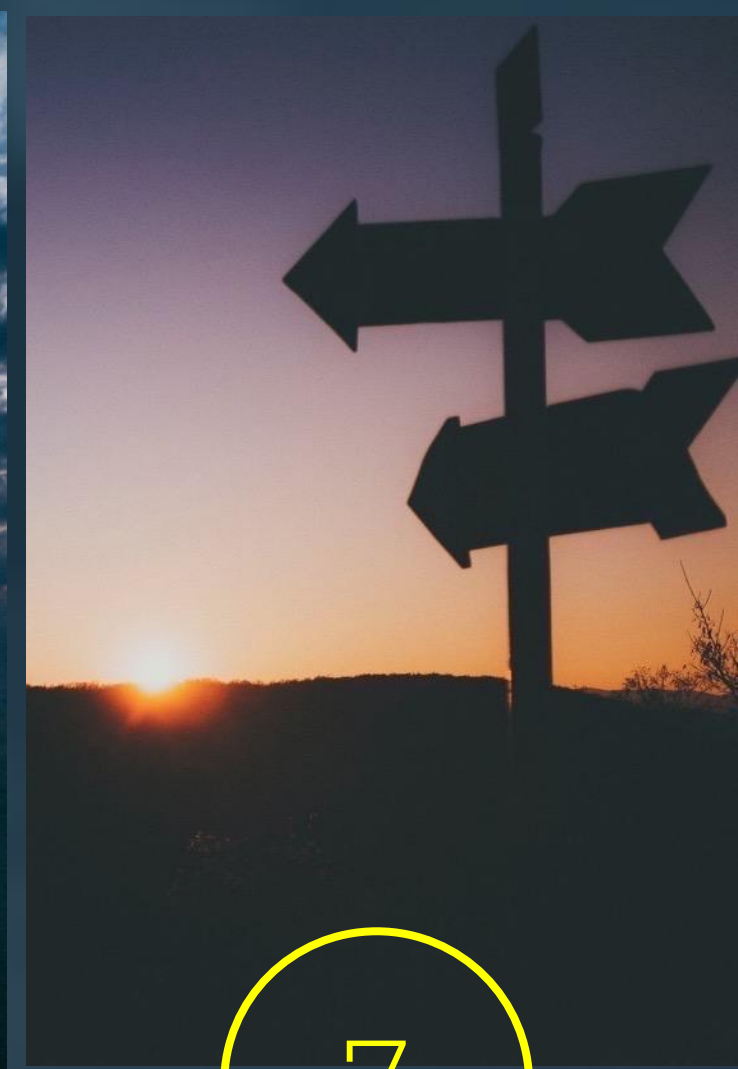
Self-evaluation of appearance is the strongest predictor of self-esteem in boys and girls globally.



6

## FAITH

Belief in God or a supreme being.



7

## VIRTUE

Adherence to a moral code makes one believe they are a good, moral and worthwhile person.



# Signs of Low Self-esteem in The Workplace



Avoiding  
Challenges or  
Opportunities



Being Excessively  
Passive or Over-  
apologising



Fear of  
Criticism



Struggling with  
Decision-Making



Negative  
Self-Talk



Overworking or  
Perfectionism



Poor Workplace  
Relationships



Reduced  
Productivity



Reluctance to  
Speak Up



Imposter  
Syndrome

# Causes of Low Self-esteem in The Workplace

1

## **Workplace Culture and Environment**

Bullying, lack of recognition or micromanagement can cause employees to feel unappreciated, insignificant, and incapable.

2

## **Poor Leadership**

Non-constructive criticism, unrealistic expectations and poor communication can create feelings of inadequacy.

3

## **Job Insecurity**

Restructuring, redundancies, or lack of career progression can cause employees to feel vulnerable, undervalued, and replaceable.

4

## **Comparison with Others**

Highly competitive environments can foster unhealthy comparisons and feelings of inadequacy

5

## **Personal Traits and Mindsets**

Such as negative self-talk, perfectionism and imposter syndrome can lead to feelings of failure, unworthiness and destructive self-criticism.

6

## **Repeated Failures or Setbacks**

Seeing mistakes, missed deadlines, or unsuccessful projects as personal flaws can undermine employee self-esteem and need to be managed.

7

## **Lack of Growth Opportunities**

Lack of opportunities for growth or advancement causes employees to feel undervalued and lacking potential.

8

## **Discrimination or Bias**

Lack of inclusivity can cause employees to feel worthless, excluded, or isolated.

9

## **Poor Work-Life Balance**

Stress and burnout due to being overloaded and overworked can impact mental well-being and lead to feelings of inadequacy.

10

## **Lack of Skills or Training**

Lacking the necessary skills or support for a role or project can create insecurity.



# Leaders - Addressing The Causes of Low Self-esteem

To counteract the causes of low self-esteem in the workplace:



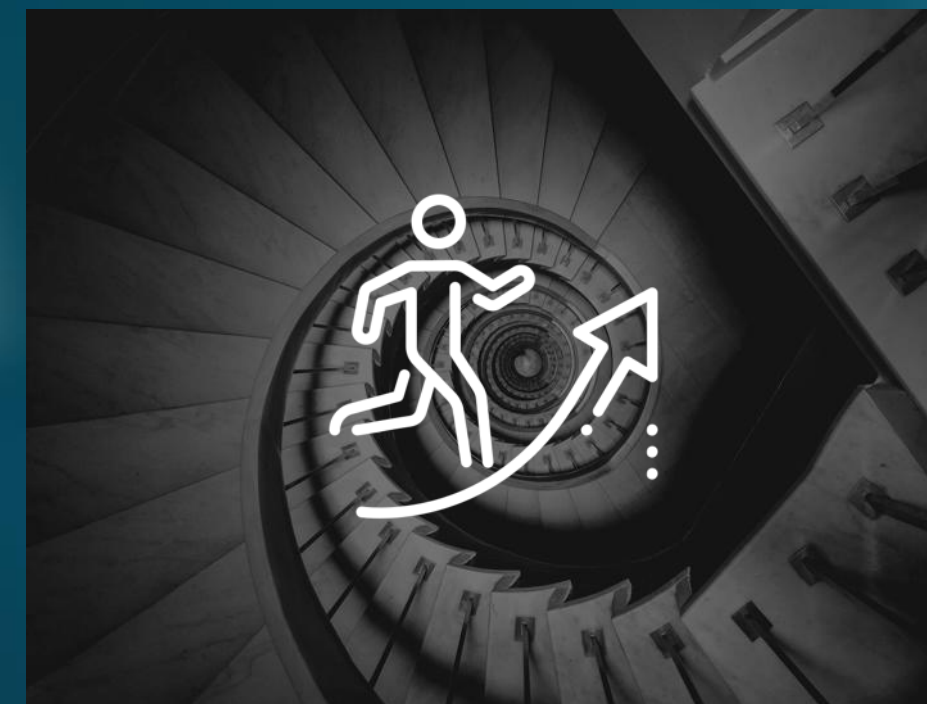
Foster a  
supportive and  
inclusive culture



Recognise  
and reward  
achievements



Provide constructive  
feedback and  
mentorship



Offer growth  
opportunities and  
skill development  
programs



Encourage open  
communication to  
address concerns  
early

*Taking these steps can help employees feel more valued, capable, and confident in their roles.*



# Self-esteem

## Best Practice

- Be kind to yourself, especially when things don't go to plan.
- Challenge negative thoughts about yourself.
- Avoid comparing yourself to others.
- Look after yourself – sleep, diet, exercise.
- Spend time outside in nature.
- Celebrate successes.
- Accept compliments and write them down.
- Build your support network.
- Be assertive – say no!



### EXERCISE

#### **LIST YOUR STRENGTHS**

Make a list of the things you are good at and refer to it from time to time – skills, traits, beliefs etc.

Ask others for their input and perspective.

# Individual Exercises to Build Self-Esteem



Daily affirmations



Gratitude journaling



Strengths-focused reflection



Set achievable goals



Positive visualisation



Practising assertiveness



Volunteer or help others



Reframe negative thoughts



Physical exercise or yoga



Social connections